

Project, Stakeholder, and Requirements Management... Fundamentals

Module 1

Project Management Essentials

Module 2

Stakeholder Management Essentials

Module 3

Requirements Management and Generative AI Applications

Lesson 1: Requirements Elicitation and Management

Understanding Different Types of Requirements

Video • 7 min

What Is Agile Business Analysis?

Video • 7 min

Requirements Elicitation: Your Role

Video • 8 min

Activity: Podcast: Eliciting Requirements Using Stakeholder Interviews

Ungraded Plugin • 3 min

Activity: Eliciting Requirements from Stakeholder Interviews

Role Play • 15 min

Eliciting Agile Requirements

Video • 7 min

Prioritizing Requirements

Video • 6 min

Reading: Elicitation Cheat Sheet

Ungraded Plugin • 4 min

Lab: Affinity Charting

Ungraded Plugin • 25 min

Practice Quiz: Requirements Elicitation and Management

Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Lesson 2: Requirements Management and Use of AI

Generative AI for Project Management

Video • 5 min

Leveraging the Power of GenAI in Project Management

Video • 5 min

Leveraging the Power of GenAI

Reading • 5 min

AI in Requirements Elicitation

Video • 6 min

Challenges of GenAI

Video • 7 min

Advantages and Challenges of GenAI

Reading • 5 min

Reading: Cheat Sheet for GenAI Prompts

Ungraded Plugin • 6 min

Lab: Elicit Requirements Using AI

Ungraded Plugin • 40 min

Practice Quiz: Requirements Management and Use of AI

Practice Assignment • 10 min

Lesson 3: Module Summary and Assessment

Podcast: Recap of Requirements Management and Generative AI Applications

Ungraded Plugin • 3 min

Graded Quiz: Requirements Management and Generative AI Applications

Graded Assignment • 21 min

Module 4

Final Project, Final Exam, and Course Wrap-Up

Lesson 1: Common Tools for Managing Project

Podcast: Tools for Project Management

Ungraded Plugin • 5 min

Demo Video: Project Management Tools

Video • 5 min

Lab: Building a Gantt Chart and Milestone Chart: SOP Update for Inventory Management

Ungraded Plugin • 15 min

Practice Quiz: Common Tools for Managing Project

Practice Assignment • 6 min

Advantages and Challenges of GenAI

Generative AI has transformed how organizations approach project management and innovation. Yet, as powerful as it is, this technology introduces unique challenges that must be understood and managed effectively. By the end of this reading, you will be able to identify key challenges that arise while using generative AI and outline best practices to overcome them.

Imagine you're a department head leading a cross-team AI project. Data privacy requirements are unclear, legacy systems resist integration, and your team lacks AI expertise. As a non-project manager, you take action by ensuring regulatory compliance, training your team, and planning for scalability. By doing so, you transform challenges into opportunities, manage risks effectively, and lead the project toward a successful, value-driven outcome.

Generative AI empowers organizations to embrace innovation, execute value-driven projects, and enhance performance. While it offers enormous potential, it also introduces several challenges that must be addressed to ensure success. Beyond formal project managers, many professionals — such as team leads, department heads, and operational managers — perform project management functions. For them, AI tools streamline planning, automate updates, and improve communication, making it easier to manage complex activities and deliver results with clarity and confidence.

Let's now examine the major challenges that come with implementing generative AI.

One of the first challenges involves **interfaces and system integration**. Generative AI systems must integrate smoothly with existing or legacy systems to provide full functionality. However, many legacy systems cannot accommodate AI technologies, leading to degraded performance or limited features. To address this, project leaders must identify system dependencies early and plan integration strategies that ensure compatibility.

Another significant issue is **governance and data security**. Generative AI models often rely on large volumes of data, including sensitive or proprietary information. Without proper safeguards, this data can be exposed or misused, leading to breaches, intellectual property loss, or privacy violations. It's the project manager's responsibility to ensure compliance with regulations and protect all confidential information.

Scalability is also a key consideration. As organizations expand their use of AI, ensuring that systems can handle greater volumes of data and complexity becomes critical. Any blockers to scaling can limit the value and reach of AI solutions. Project managers must plan for growth from the outset to ensure the solution remains sustainable and adaptable.

Cost-benefit analysis presents another challenge. Generative AI projects require substantial investments of time, talent, and financial resources. Project teams must confirm that the expected benefits justify the costs and that AI adoption truly enhances competitiveness and delivers a strong return on investment.

Equally important is **team composition**. Successful AI implementation depends on having a skilled, diverse, and adaptable team. A shortage of AI talent can limit project scope, delay timelines, and increase costs. Building the right mix of skills — through hiring, partnerships, or training — is essential.

Finally, **ethics and bias** represent ongoing risks. Generative AI models are only as fair and accurate as the data and algorithms behind them. Biased data or flawed model design can lead to skewed outcomes, customer dissatisfaction, brand damage, or even project failure. Ethical breaches can affect not just organizations but individuals and society as a whole. Identifying and mitigating bias must be a continuous process.

Let's now move on to best practices that help overcome these challenges.

First, maintain **regulatory compliance**. Every project should follow the organization's data-sharing policies. If these policies are unclear, create clear guidelines, include them in the project management plan, and document related risks in the project risk register. Engage legal and intellectual property experts to ensure compliance, establish safeguards to prevent breaches, and implement robust data management systems that align with privacy regulations.

Second, ensure **ethical integrity** in AI projects. Regularly audit models to identify bias, involve diverse stakeholders in model development, and establish clear ethical guidelines that govern AI design and deployment. Understand copyright and patent implications and apply strict quality control measures to detect and resolve potential issues before they affect project outcomes.

Third, **optimize resources**. Make sure the project has access to the right skills and competencies to leverage generative AI effectively. Analyze each project charter to define roles and responsibilities, assess current team capabilities, and identify gaps. Communicate these findings to leadership and develop strategies to fill skill shortages through training or recruitment. Include AI training work packages in the work breakdown structure, keep teams updated on AI trends, and ensure resource allocation is cost-effective.

Perform regular **cost-benefit analyses** to measure value delivery, prioritize essential features, and maximize ROI. Also, establish a strong **communication plan** — consistent, clear updates and collaboration ensure the project stays aligned and responsive.

Fourth, plan for **scaling and integration** from the start. Understand the technical and architectural requirements necessary to expand AI initiatives. Identify and accommodate interface upgrades, compatibility needs, and potential integration gaps. Implement scalable technologies such as cloud-based infrastructure and ensure the solution integrates seamlessly with existing systems.

To summarize, generative AI offers project managers and organizational leaders powerful tools to innovate, streamline operations, and deliver greater value. However, success depends on proactively managing challenges related to system integration, data security, scalability, team expertise, and ethical responsibility.

By following best practices — maintaining regulatory compliance, fostering ethical awareness, ensuring skilled resources, and designing scalable solutions — organizations can mitigate risks, strengthen project outcomes, and realize the full potential of generative AI.

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Venkatesh

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Generative AI introduces both opportunities and challenges in project management and innovation that require careful handling to ensure success.

Challenges of Generative AI Implementation

Integration with legacy systems can be difficult, requiring early identification of dependencies and compatibility planning.

Governance and data security are critical due to the use of sensitive data, necessitating compliance with regulations and protection of confidential information.

Best Practices to Overcome Challenges

Maintain regulatory compliance by establishing clear data policies, involving legal experts, and documenting risks.

Ensure ethical integrity by auditing for bias, involving diverse stakeholders, and applying strict quality controls.

Resource and Scalability Management

Optimize resources by assessing team skills, filling gaps through training or hiring, and conducting cost-benefit analyses.

Plan for scalability from the start by understanding technical requirements, upgrading interfaces, and using scalable infrastructure.

By addressing these areas, organizations can leverage generative AI effectively to drive innovation, manage risks, and deliver value in projects.

And if you want to continue exploring this topic, try one of these follow-up questions:

What are the main challenges of integrating generative AI with legacy systems?

How can you ensure data security and regulatory compliance in AI projects?

How would you design a scalable AI project plan addressing team skills and ethics?

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